

SMB and Mid-Market Business Practice Requirements

The [SMB and Mid-Market Business Practice](#) is an invitation-only Competency designed for partners serving customers in the SMB and Mid-Market segments. This new competency recognizes partners with expertise delivering demand-led, scalable solutions to customers, helping them to stand out in a competitive market.

By achieving the SMB and Mid-Market Business Practice, eligible partners can further demonstrate their capabilities. They have the opportunity to deepen their knowledge of business and technical sales, explore new marketing opportunities for growth, and leverage cutting-edge technology solutions. This positions them to drive meaningful outcomes for customers in this important segment.

This is an invitation only Partner Competency. To learn more, please contact your Cisco Representative.

Knowledge requirements and personnel

Two or more individuals are required to complete the Black Belt learning plans for one or more roles, ensuring that between them, each of the four roles are completed. Each person does not need to complete every role themselves, but all requirements for all four roles must be covered.

- There are learning requirements for four (4) roles: Business Sellers, Technical Sellers, Marketing, and Tools Expert. Learning requirements for each role must be completed.
- To satisfy the requirements for a role, an individual must complete all the learning stages for that role. There is no role-sharing within individual roles of the SMB and Mid-Market Business Practice.
- 2 or more individuals must each complete the learning requirements for one or more roles, ensuring all 4 roles are completed.
- Role-sharing is allowed within the Competency as a whole – 1 individual may hold 2 or more roles.

Example 1:

Individual 1 completes all 3 stages for Business Seller role.

Individual 2 completes all 3 stages for Technical Sellers, Marketing and Tools Expert roles.

Example 2:

Individual 1 completes all 3 stages for Business Seller role.

Individual 2 completes all 3 stages for Technical Sellers role.

Individual 3 completes all 3 stages for Marketing role.

Individual 4 completes all 3 stages for Tools Expert role.

- There are no role-sharing limitations with other Competencies or Specializations.
- **Two or more individuals must each complete the learning requirements for one or more roles, ensuring all 4 roles are completed.**

Role	Requirements	Training and assessment	
		Cost (USD)	Duration (estimate)
General (All individuals must first complete this training)	Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Platform for Partnership Stage 1 (Nov 2025)	\$0	2.5 hr
Business Sellers	FIRST COMPLETE SMB and Mid-Market Platform for Partnership Stage 1 Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Business Seller LAER Stage 2 (Dec 2025) Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Business Seller Challenge Stage 3 (Jan 2026)	\$0	6 hr
Technical Sellers	FIRST COMPLETE SMB and Mid-Market Platform for Partnership Stage 1 Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Technical Seller LAER Stage 2 (Jan 2026) Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Technical Seller Challenge Stage 3 (Jan 2026)	\$0	7 hr
Marketing	FIRST COMPLETE SMB and Mid-Market Platform for Partnership Stage 1 Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Marketing LAER Stage 2 (Jan 2026) Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Marketing Challenge Stage 3 (Jan 2026)	\$0	5.5 hr
Tools Expert	FIRST COMPLETE SMB and Mid-Market Platform for Partnership Stage 1 Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Tools Expert LAER Stage 2 (Jan 2026) Black Belt SMB and Mid-Market Tools Expert Challenge Stage 3 (Jan 2026)	\$0	5.5 hr
Total hours		\$0	26.5 hr

Bookings requirement

To qualify for an invitation to apply to the SMB and Mid-Market Business Practice at launch, Partners must have met a minimum bookings requirement threshold of \$200k in SMB and Mid-Market product only bookings, achieved either in FY25 or during FY25H2 & FY26H1

An ongoing bookings requirement of at least \$200k will be necessary to comply with the program requirements and to be invited to renew the Competency.

Ongoing requirements for renewals

Partners must maintain compliance with all Competency requirements, including role and bookings requirements. Partners must also submit for renewal by your Competency renewal anniversary date each year. Make sure to bookmark the program notifications page and check back regularly for updates. Partner Administrators may view Competency status in the [PMA tool](#).

Additional considerations

Country groupings

Can one Competency apply across different countries? Yes, but only within one [country grouping](#).

Related information

Exam cost and duration

The Information provided for cost and duration is an estimate only and is subject to change.

Note: If you do not remain in compliance with the application Competency or certification requirements, we reserve the right to revoke the Competency or certification at any time. You must notify us of non-compliance promptly, but in no event more than thirty (30) days after you first become aware of the non-compliance. Upon receipt of such notice, you may qualify for an extension of time in which to renew your compliance with the applicable Competency or certification requirements. Your failure to provide such notice may disqualify you from receiving such an extension. If no extension is granted or if you fail to comply with the certification or Competency requirements by the end of the extension period, we reserve the right to revoke the application Competency or certification immediately. Additional information regarding non-compliance may be found in the [Specialization and Competency Policy Document](#).

Document Revision History

Revision history	Date	Changes
1.0	Jan 25, 2026	Program launch including program requirements
1.1	April 10, 2026	Updated Black Belt titles to include month and year



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